- Eat low-fat meals
- Exercise regularly 4–5 times a week
- Monitor weight regularly.

Case Study

A lady aged 30 is a rich housewife without much work. She is fond of eating sweets, fried foods, ice creams etc. She spends most of her time by watching T.V. Her height is 5.5" and weight is 100 kg. Her blood cholesterol level is 220 mg / dl. Her BP is 90mm/130mm. She thinks putting on weight is natural phenomena, Suggest her a diet and behavior modification to reduce her weight.

DO YOU KNOW?

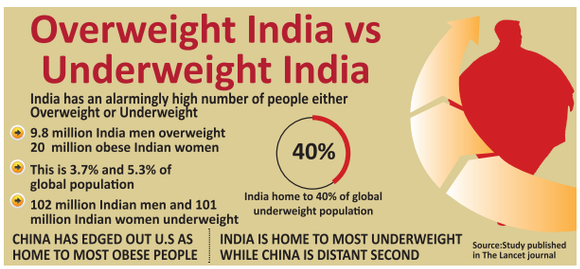
Anti obesity day is on 26th November

7.2. UNDERWEIGHT

Underweight is defined as people with a body mass index (BMI) of less than 18.5 or a body weight 15% to 20 % below the normal for their age and height. Underweight results when the energy balance is negative.

DO YOU KNOW?

An estimated 50 million adult women are classified as being severely underweight in developing countries.



7.2.1 Aetiology

Genes

There is a genetic cause associated with being under weight. The weight of an individual is inherited basically from his biological mother. If the biological mother being thin, there is 75% likelihood of the individual being thin also.

Dietary factors:

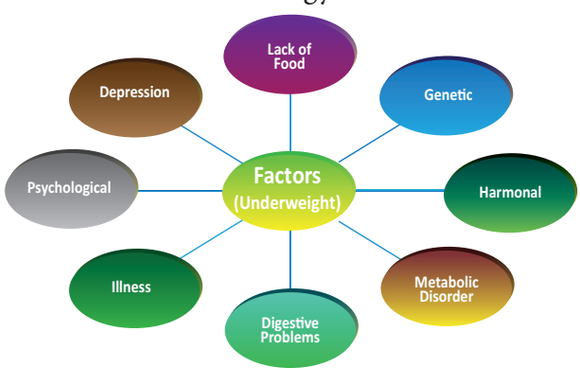
Poor selection of food along with irregular eating habits may be responsible for insufficient food intake and hence calorie intake. It may be due to ignorance or a lack of purchasing power of the family.

Physical activity and psychological factor:

Individuals who are tense, nervous and extremely active and who do not rest sufficiently tend to expend more energy than what they are able to eat. This can cause under nutrition.

Pathologic condition:

Fever and infections, increase the demand for energy, if not met because of poor appetite, lead to loss of weight. Food intake may be severely limited by nausea, vomiting or diarrhoea in gastrointestinal disturbances. Metabolic rate may be greatly increased in hyperthyroidism resulting in underweight. Drug therapy may also alter taste or reduce appetite, leading to weight loss. Wasting diseases such as tuberculosis, diabetes, cancer and malabsorption syndrome increases the metabolic rate and energy needs.



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